

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 798

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Dave Owens, 2025
NWTF Grand National Calling Champion.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly recognize those individuals whose extraordinary accomplishments bring distinction to their field and reflect positively on events hosted in the great State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Dave Owens, who was named Senior Division Champion at the 2025 Grand National Calling Championships, held during the annual convention of the National Wild Turkey Federation (NWTF) in Nashville; a contest widely regarded as the "Super Bowl" of the turkey calling world, the event represents the pinnacle of competitive turkey calling and draws the finest callers from across the nation; and

WHEREAS, in the final moments of the 2025 competition, Dave Owens stood alongside nine-time champion Matt Van Cise as one of the last two contenders, ultimately being named the winner of this highly coveted event; and

WHEREAS, this championship marks the fulfillment of a longtime goal for Mr. Owens, whose win was not only a personal triumph but a moment of recognition for a philosophy of hunting rooted in authenticity, perseverance, and respect for wild turkeys; and

WHEREAS, Dave Owens, who resides in Cherokee, Alabama, has deep experience in turkey hunting and competitive calling, having previously won the 2018 Grand National Senior Division Open Champion title and the Georgia State Championship; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Owens is the founder of the Pinhoti Project, a video series that presents turkey hunting in a realistic and minimalist style, showcasing a more accessible, effort-based approach that places the focus on the wild turkey itself and the experience of the hunt; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his work as a hunter, videographer, and championship caller, Dave Owens serves on the board of Turkeys for Tomorrow, a nonprofit conservation organization committed to science-based management practices that benefit wild turkey populations and other wildlife species; and

WHEREAS, Dave Owens is known for his commitment to helping others, as demonstrated by his involvement with the KT Team, an organization that assists disabled hunters in enjoying the outdoors and overcoming challenges in the field; and

WHEREAS, through his championship title, his conservation leadership, and his widely respected media work, Mr. Owens has become a key figure in the hunting community and continues to inspire others with his dedication to ethical hunting and wildlife stewardship; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Dave Owens upon his victory at the 2025 NWTF Grand National Calling Championship, recognize his ongoing contributions to the future of turkey hunting and conservation, and extend to him our best wishes for continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.